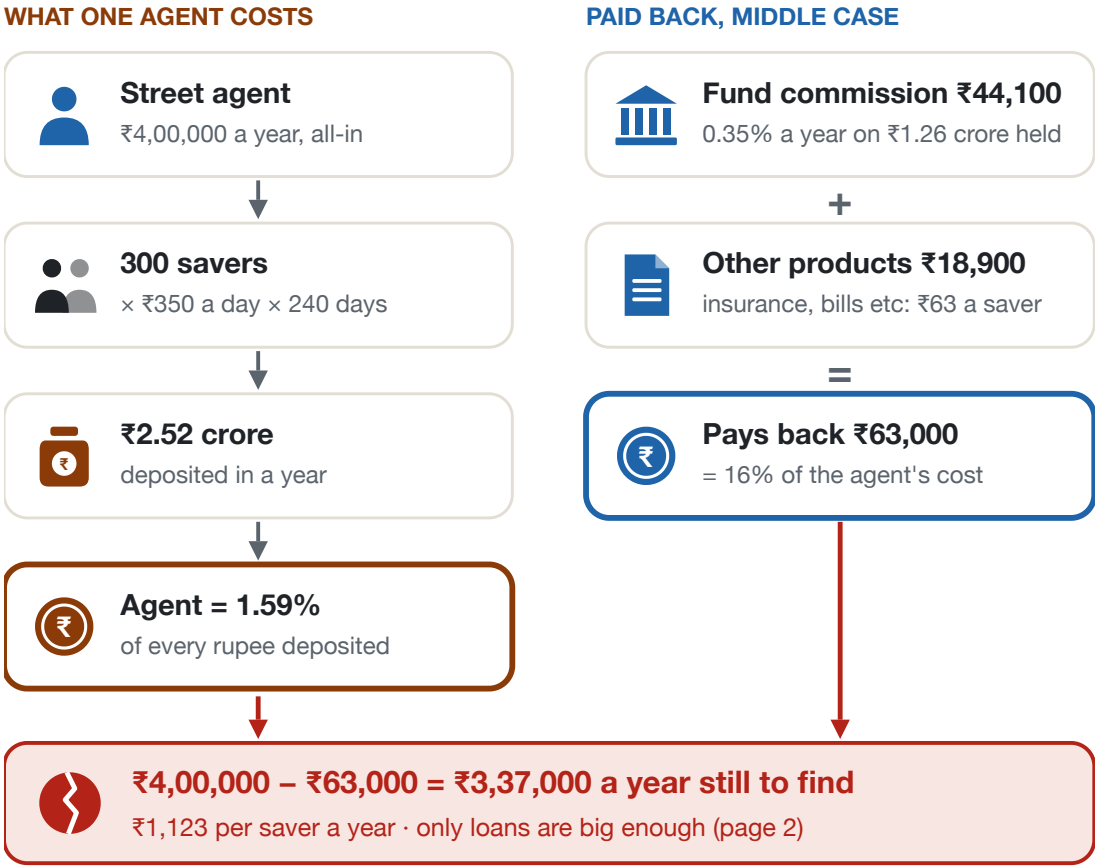
One street agent costs ₹4 lakh a year. On a janta-size book that is 1.6% of deposits, and what his savers buy pays only 16% of it.



How many savers one agent needs for ₹4 lakh to be 1.5% of deposits

EACH SAVER PUTS IN	DEPOSITS A YEAR	SAVERS NEEDED	COST IF HE HAS 300
₹51 a day Bachatt's minimum	₹12,240	✗ 2,179	10.9%
₹100 a day our model's saver	₹24,000	✗ 1,111	5.6%
₹350 a day Arvinder's middle	₹84,000	✓ 317	1.6%
₹500 a day Arvinder's top	₹1,20,000	✓ 222	1.1%

✗ = more savers than one person can visit every day (Arvinder visits 200–400).

What his 300 savers pay back in a year

	LOW	MIDDLE	HIGH
Fund commission, 0.20 / 0.35 / 0.50% of ₹1.26 crore held	₹25,200	₹44,100	₹63,000
Other products, ₹8 / ₹63 / ₹259 a saver	₹2,400	₹18,900	₹77,700
Total paid back	**₹27,600**	**₹63,000**	**₹1,40,700**
Share of the ₹4 lakh agent	7%	16%	35%
Gap left for loans	**₹3,72,400**	**₹3,37,000**	**₹2,59,300**

The book size works only at ₹350+ a day. Even then the savings side pays a sixth of the agent; loans must pay the rest.

Assumptions: agent ₹4,00,000 a year all-in (your figure) · 300 savers × ₹350 a day, the middle of Arvinder's 200–400 savers and ₹200–500 a day (interview, 15 Oct 2026) · 240 deposit days a year (20 a month; our estimate from Bachatt's 2M purchases ÷ ~1 lakh savers) · half a year's deposits held on average (year one, nothing withdrawn) · fund commission 0.2–0.5% a year (XB-04) · other products ₹8 / ₹63 / ₹259 a saver a year (XO-39) · shop loan ₹1.5 lakh, 12 months, 26%, our model's net after funding, losses and running cost (tables/lend_loan.csv) · referral 2% of the loan less 2.5% taken back (XL-13) · 24 of 100 savers still saving after a year (tables/lend_funnel.csv). Built by model/invert_deposit_cost.py → tables/invert_agent_*.csv.

Filling the ₹3.37 lakh gap takes 73 shop loans a year per agent: 1 for every 4 savers. The evidence shows 1 for every 33.

To fill the ₹3,37,000 gap with one product alone (all per year)

PRODUCT	EARNS PER UNIT	NEEDED PER AGENT	NEEDED PER SAVER	SAVERS BUY	SHORT BY
Lend ₹1.5L ourselves, 3% losses	₹8,816	**38**	0.13	0.03	! 4×
Lend ₹1.5L ourselves, 6% losses	₹4,594	**73**	0.24	0.03	! 8×
Refer ₹1.5L shop loan (2%)	₹2,925	**115**	0.38	0.03	✕ 13×
Refer ₹25,557 personal loan (2%)	₹498	**676**	2.25	0.03	✕ 75×
Small term-life policy	₹250	**1,348**	4.49	0.03	✕ 150×
Accident / hospital cash	₹120	**2,808**	9.36	0.06	✕ 156×
Two-wheeler insurance	₹48	**7,095**	23.65	0.15	✕ 158×

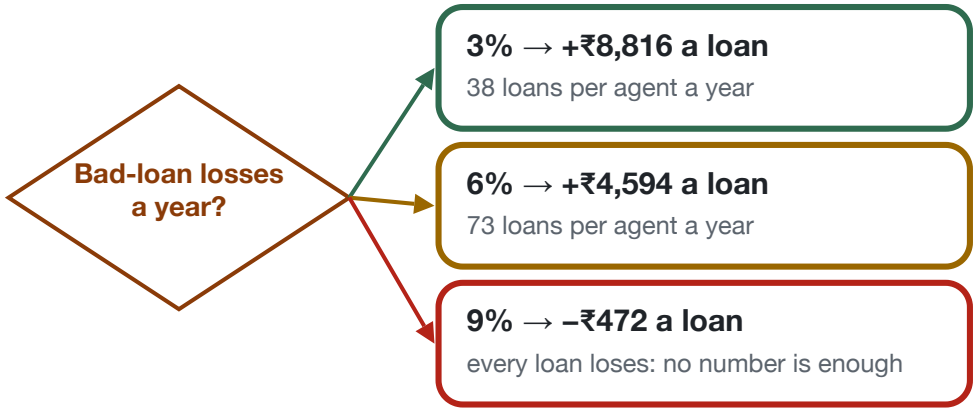
"Savers buy" for loans = approved loans per saver a year, evidence middle (range 0.01–0.08). Our model assumes 0.20: short of the 0.24 needed at 6% losses, enough at 3% (0.13).

He must sign 1,242 people to have 300 still saving a year later (24 of 100 stay): 5.2 sign-ups every working day.

UPI is the only way past 400 savers. Below ₹350 a day, one agent needs more savers than one person can visit (page 1).

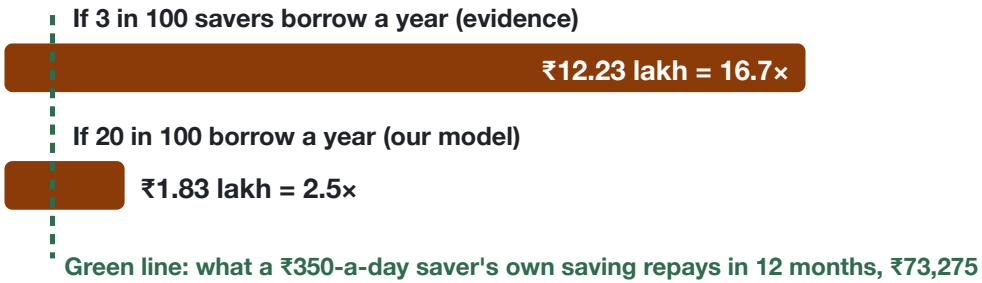
Only digital gold pays on every rupee: about 2.4% of each purchase (Jar), and the saver pays it through GST and the buy-sell gap.

DOES A ₹1.5 LAKH SHOP LOAN MAKE MONEY?



Digital lenders today run 7–10% losses; Paytm-sourced shop loans 4.5–5%.

HOW BIG EACH LOAN MUST BE (LENDING OURSELVES, 6% LOSSES)



It works only if savers borrow far more than evidence shows, loans run well above what savings repay, and losses stay near 3–6%.

Assumptions: agent ₹4,00,000 a year all-in (your figure) · 300 savers × ₹350 a day, the middle of Arvinder's 200–400 savers and ₹200–500 a day (interview, 15 Oct 2026) · 240 deposit days a year (20 a month; our estimate from Bachatt's 2M purchases ÷ ~1 lakh savers) · half a year's deposits held on average (year one, nothing withdrawn) · fund commission 0.2–0.5% a year (XB-04) · other products ₹8 / ₹63 / ₹259 a saver a year (XO-39) · shop loan ₹1.5 lakh, 12 months, 26%, our model's net after funding, losses and running cost (tables/lend_loan.csv) · referral 2% of the loan less 2.5% taken back (XL-13) · 24 of 100 savers still saving after a year (tables/lend_funnel.csv). Built by model/invert_deposit_cost.py → tables/invert_agent_*.csv.